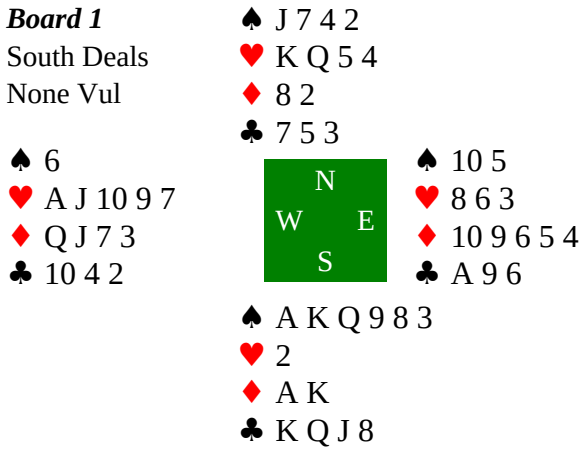
***Board 1***
South Deals
None Vul




| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 2♣ |
| Pass | 2♦ | Pass | 2♠ |
| Pass | 3♠ | Pass | 4NT[1] |
| Pass | 5♣[2] | Pass | 5♠ |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces

5♠ by South
Lead: ♦Q

NORTH's 3♠ supporting bid is enough to convince SOUTH to make a slam try.

SOUTH bids Blackwood 4NT. If NORTH shows one Ace SOUTH plans to bid 6♠, but when NORTH bids 5♣ SOUTH settles for 5♠

***Board 2***
North Deals
N-S Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ A 6 4<br>♥ K J 9<br>♦ A K Q J 9<br>♣ K Q | |
| ♠ K 9 8 7 5<br>♥ 7 4<br>♦ 7 6 5 4<br>♣ A 6 | | ♠ Q 10 2<br>♥ 5 3 2<br>♦ 8 2<br>♣ 9 8 5 3 2 |
| | ♠ J 3<br>♥ A Q 10 8 6<br>♦ 10 3<br>♣ J 10 7 4 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 2♣ | Pass | 2♥ |
| Pass | 4NT[1] | Pass | 5♦[2] |
| Pass | 6♥ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

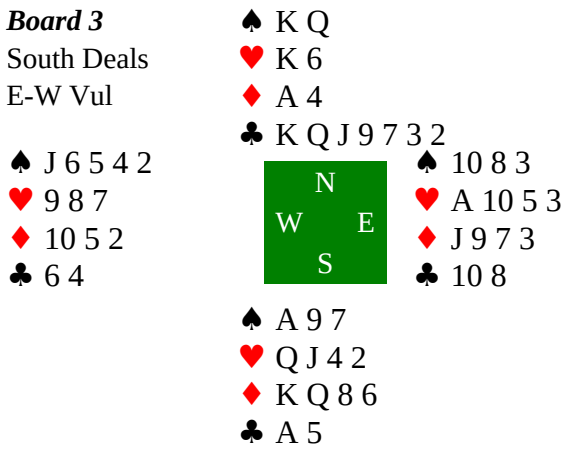
1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♥ by South
Lead: ♣A

SOUTH makes a positive 3♥ response to NORTH's 2♣ opener. This promises at least 8 points and a 5-card suit with two or more honors.

NORTH only needs to know one thing - how many Aces in the SOUTH hand. A Blackwood 4NT tells her the answer is one, so she bids 6♥.

***Board 3***
South Deals
E-W Vul




| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1NT |
| Pass | 4♣ | Pass | 4♠ |
| Pass | 6NT | | |
| All Pass | | | |

6NT by South
Lead: ♠4

When SOUTH opens 1NT, point-count alone tells NORTH that 6NT can surely be made. SOUTH is bound to hold at least two Aces. But NORTH doesn't want to miss a Grand slam.

NORTH bids 4♣, (Gerber), and SOUTH admits to just two Aces.

So NORTH settles for the small slam.

***Board 4***
North Deals
Both Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ J 9 5 2<br>♥ A J 7 4 3<br>♦ A Q<br>♣ 9 8 | |
| ♠ 8<br>♥ Q 10<br>♦ J 9 6 5 4 2<br>♣ Q J 3 2 | | ♠ 10 7<br>♥ 9 8 6 2<br>♦ 10 8<br>♣ 10 7 6 5 4 |
| | ♠ A K Q 6 4 3<br>♥ K 5<br>♦ K 7 3<br>♣ A K | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 1♥ | Pass | 2♠ |
| Pass | 3♠ | Pass | 4NT[1] |
| Pass | 5♥[2] | Pass | 7NT |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

7NT by South
Lead: ♣Q

SOUTH has a powerhouse and knows she will reach a slam somewhere. When NORTH supports the ♠s, it seems she has found her spot.

Blackwood tells her that NORTH has two Aces. She can see there are 12 tricks available and decides to take a chance that NORTH will have a thirteenth trick somewhere among his opening hand points.

She bids 7NT.

***Board 5***
North Deals
None Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ A K 2<br>♥ K Q 6 5<br>♦ K Q J<br>♣ K J 6 | |
| ♠ 9 8 4<br>♥ 4 3<br>♦ A 7 6 4<br>♣ 10 5 4 3 | N<br>W E<br>S | ♠ Q 10 6 5<br>♥ 7 2<br>♦ 10 9 5<br>♣ A 9 7 2 |
| | ♠ J 7 3<br>♥ A J 10 9 8<br>♦ 8 3 2<br>♣ Q 8 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 2♣ | Pass | 2♥ |
| Pass | 4NT[1] | Pass | 5♦[2] |
| Pass | 5♥ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

5♥ by South
Lead: ♦A

NORTH is tempted to go right to 6♥ when she hears SOUTH's positive response. BUT, she should use Blackwood first.

It's good thing she did because SOUTH admits to only one Ace - they are missing two Aces.

***Board 6***
North Deals
E-W Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ K Q 4<br>♥ A 8<br>♦ K Q J 10 7 3<br>♣ K 5 | |
| ♠ 10 9 2<br>♥ 9 5 4 3 2<br>♦ 6 5<br>♣ 10 3 2 | | ♠ J 8 7 5<br>♥ Q J 6<br>♦ 8 2<br>♣ A J 6 4 |
| | ♠ A 6 3<br>♥ K 10 7<br>♦ A 9 4<br>♣ Q 9 8 7 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 1♦ | Pass | 2NT |
| Pass | 4♣ | Pass | 4♠ |
| Pass | 6NT | | |
| All Pass | | | |

6NT by South
Lead: ♥5

NORTH not only has 20 points, he also has a lot of winners. So when SOUTH jumps to 2NT, showing 13-15 points, NORTH uses Gerber.

SOUTH shows two Aces so NORTH decides 6NT will be just right.

***Board 7***
North Deals
None Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ K Q 8 5<br>♥ J 6 3<br>♦ 8 7<br>♣ A Q J 4 | |
| ♠ 10 7<br>♥ K Q 10 9 8 7<br>♦ 5<br>♣ 10 8 6 3 | | ♠ 4 2<br>♥ 5 2<br>♦ K 10 9 4 3 2<br>♣ 9 7 2 |
| | ♠ A J 9 6 3<br>♥ A 4<br>♦ A Q J 6<br>♣ K 5 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 1♣ | Pass | 2♠ |
| Pass | 3♠ | Pass | 4NT[1] |
| Pass | 5♠[2] | Pass | 5NT[3] |
| Pass | 6♣[4] | Pass | 6♠ |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 3 aces
3. asks for kings
4. 0 kings

6♠ by South
Lead: ♦5

When NORTH gives immediate ♠ support, SOUTH's thoughts naturally turn to slam. This is a good hand to use Blackwood on, so SOUTH bids 4NT.

NORTH's 5♦ answer shows one Ace, which SOUTH cleverly deduces must be the ♣A.

SOUTH bids 6♠ since NORTH has not bid strongly enough to think about 7.

***Board 8***
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q J
♥ A K 10
♦ K Q 2
♣ K Q 7 3

♠ 9 7 2
♥ 3 2
♦ 10 6 4
♣ A 10 9 4 2

♠ 10 8 5 3
♥ 6 5
♦ A 7 5
♣ J 8 6 5

♠ A 6 4
♥ Q J 9 8 7 4
♦ J 9 8 3
♣ —

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 2♣ | Pass | 2♥ |
| Pass | 3♥ | Pass | 3♠ |
| Pass | 4NT | Pass | 6♣ |
| Pass | 6♥ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

6♥ by South
Lead: ♦4

NORTH expects to bid 2NT at his second turn, but SOUTH gives a positive 2♥ response and his thinking changes! First he supports ♥s, setting the trump suit.

SOUTH then bids 3♠, showing first round control. NORTH tries 4NT (Blackwood) and SOUTH replies 6♣. This shows a ♣ void and one Ace, obviously the ♠A.

NORTH bids 6♥, knowing they must lose the ♦A.

***Board 9***
South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A 8 4 2
♥ Q J 8 6
♦ A 9 8 6 3
♣ —

♠ Q J 6
♥ 9 2
♦ J 5
♣ K 8 7 5 4 2

♠ 10 9 7 3
♥ 4
♦ Q 10 4 2
♣ A Q 10 3

♠ K 5
♥ A K 10 7 5 3
♦ K 7
♣ J 9 6

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♥ |
| Pass | 4♣ | Pass | 4NT |
| Pass | 5NT | Pass | 7♥ |
| All Pass | | | |

7♥ by South
Lead: ♦J

NORTH's jump to 4♣ is a Splinter bid, at least 4-card ♥ support, at least opening hand, and a ♣ Singleton or Void.

SOUTH bids 4NT, Blackwood.

NORTH's 5NT reply shows two Aces and a Void somewhere, obviously ♣s.

SOUTH counts thirteen tricks and bids 7♥.

***Board 10***
South Deals
None Vul

♠ —
♥ A 9 7 5
♦ K 9 8 6 4
♣ J 9 3 2

♠ Q 10 7 2
♥ 4 2
♦ Q J 5 3 2
♣ 7 4

♠ A J 9 8 6 4
♥ 8 6
♦ 10 7
♣ A 8 5

♠ K 5 3
♥ K Q J 10 3
♦ A
♣ K Q 10 6

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♥ |
| Pass | 3♥ | Pass | 4NT |
| Pass | 6♥ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

6♥ by South
Lead: ♣7

SOUTH figures that if NORTH holds two Aces he will bid the slam.

NORTH only has one Ace, but she has something else just as good - a void in a suit which is higher-ranking than ♥s.

SOUTH manages to figure out that NORTH has a ♠ void and bids the slam anyway.

***Board 11***
South Deals
None Vul

♠ K 7 5 3
♥ J 8 7
♦ A 8 6 5
♣ 7 4

♠ Q J
♥ 10 9 6 3
♦ K 10 9 4
♣ 10 9 8

♠ 10 2
♥ 5 4 2
♦ Q J 3 2
♣ A Q 5 2

♠ A 9 8 6 4
♥ A K Q
♦ 7
♣ K J 6 3

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♠ |
| Pass | 2♠ | Pass | 4♠ |
| All Pass | | | |

4♠ by South
Lead: ♣10

SOUTH may have a good hand but NORTH merely gave a simple raise. Even if NORTH has a maximum there won't be a slam.

***Board 12***
South Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 7 5 3
♥ 10 9 4 2
♦ A 8
♣ K J 4

♠ K J 8 6
♥ 5
♦ Q 9 7 6 3
♣ 10 8 2

♠ A 10 9 4 2
♥ A 7
♦ 10 5 4
♣ 9 7 3

♠ —
♥ K Q J 8 6 3
♦ K J 2
♣ A Q 6 5

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♥ |
| Pass | 3♥ | Pass | 4♣ |
| Pass | 4♦ | Pass | 6♥ |
| All Pass | | | |

6♥ by South
Lead: ♥5

SOUTH has a tough decision after the two Control-showing bids.

If he uses Blackwood and NORTH shows two Aces he will be no better off, because he won't know if one of the Aces is the useless ♠A. Based on knowing that NORTH holds the ♦A, he bids 6♥, hoping that he can at least make that and that 7 isn't a laydown!

***Board 13***
South Deals
Both Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ A 7<br>♥ K 3<br>♦ Q J 9 8 7 4 2<br>♣ 7 6 | |
| ♠ 10 9 4 3<br>♥ Q J 4<br>♦ 10<br>♣ Q J 10 9 3 | N<br>W E<br>S | ♠ Q J 8 5<br>♥ 8 7 6 5 2<br>♦ 6 5<br>♣ 5 2 |
| | ♠ K 6 2<br>♥ A 10 9<br>♦ A K 3<br>♣ A K 8 4 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 2NT |
| Pass | 4♣ | Pass | 4NT[1] |
| Pass | 5♣[2] | Pass | 5NT[3] |
| Pass | 7NT | | |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces
3. asks for kings

7NT by South
Lead: ♣Q

NORTH isn't sure just how much he can make, but surely 6♦ isn't too much to hope for.

He starts with a Gerber 4♣ and SOUTH shows three Aces.

Hmmm, 5♣ asks for Kings and SOUTH shows three.

Hmm, NORTH can now count all thirteen tricks, so he forgets about the ♦ slam and bids 7NT.

***Board 14***
South Deals
None Vul

♠ J 8
♥ J 7 2
♦ 8 5
♣ A K Q 10 9 6

♠ 10 6 5 3
♥ 9 4
♦ A 9 7 6 4 2
♣ 4

♠ 9 7 4 2
♥ A 10 8 5 3
♦ J 10
♣ 3 2

♠ A K Q
♥ K Q 6
♦ K Q 3
♣ J 8 7 5

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 2NT |
| Pass | 4♣ | Pass | 4♥ |
| Pass | 4NT | | |
| All Pass | | | |

4NT by South
Lead: ♥9

NORTH has 13 points and can contribute six tricks so she figures that twelve tricks will be a slam (dunk).

However, just to make sure the opponents don't take the first two tricks she checks with Gerber.

Uh Oh, missing two Aces she signs off at 4NT. She could also happily play 5♣, but it would be tricky to get there. Very tricky.

***Board 15***
South Deals
N-S Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ A Q 6<br>♥ K 7 3<br>♦ K 6<br>♣ K 10 6 5 3 | |
| ♠ 9 4 3<br>♥ A 8 5 4<br>♦ J 7 4 2<br>♣ 9 4 | N<br>W E<br>S | ♠ J 10 8 2<br>♥ J 10 2<br>♦ Q 10 5<br>♣ J 8 2 |
| | ♠ K 7 5<br>♥ Q 9 6<br>♦ A 9 8 3<br>♣ A Q 7 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1NT |
| Pass | 4NT | | |
| All Pass | | | |

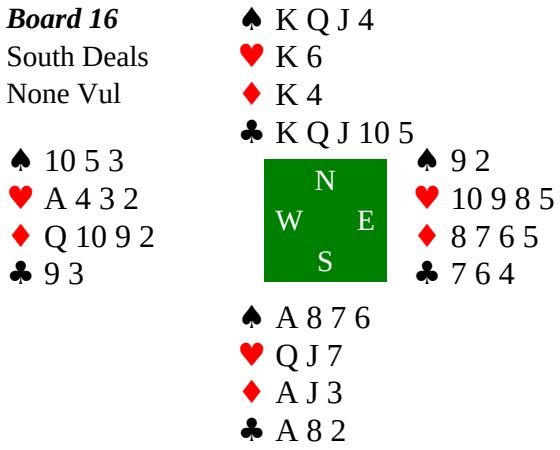
4NT by South
Lead: ♥4

Yes, this has nothing to do with Gerber or Blackwood, but everything to do with smart bidding.

NORTH has a 16 points and SOUTH has 15, 16 or 17. NORTH wants to be in 6NT if SOUTH has 17, but merely a Notrump game if she has 15 or 16.

The way to find out is to bid 4NT - not Blackwood but merely an invitation to bid 6NT. In this case, SOUTH has but 15 points and declines the invitation. If her ♥Q were changed to the ♥A she would bid 6NT and collect her twelve easy tricks.

***Board 16***
South Deals
None Vul




| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1NT |
| Pass | 4♣ | Pass | 4NT |
| Pass | 6NT | | |
| All Pass | | | |

6NT by South
Lead: ♠5

When SOUTH opens 1NT NORTH hopes his hand includes all four Aces so she can bid 7NT. So she uses Gerber to find out.

But, when she discovers they are missing an Ace she settles for 6NT.

***Board 17***
South Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 7 2
♥ K J 5 3
♦ K 7
♣ 7 6 4 2

♠ Q J 10 6
♥ 8 2
♦ 9 5 2
♣ J 9 8 5

♠ 8 5 4 3
♥ 7 4
♦ 10 8 6 4
♣ Q 10 3

♠ A K
♥ A Q 10 9 6
♦ A Q J 3
♣ A K

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 2♣ |
| Pass | 2♦ | Pass | 2♥ |
| Pass | 3♥ | Pass | 4NT[1] |
| Pass | 5♣[2] | Pass | 5NT[3] |
| Pass | 6♥[4] | Pass | 7NT |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces
3. asks for kings
4. 2 kings

7NT by South
Lead: ♠Q

SOUTH has a pretty good hand, and when NORTH shows ♥ support she naturally thinks about slam.

She has all four Aces but she wants to know about Kings. Unfortunately she can't start at 5NT because that has a different meaning, so she goes through the 4NT sequence even though she already knows the Ace answer.

Finding NORTH with two Kings was what she wanted.

***Board 18***
North Deals
N-S Vul

♠ K 7
♥ K 9
♦ A Q J 10 4
♣ A Q J 7

♠ Q 10 9 5
♥ Q 8 5 3
♦ 9 8 2
♣ 5 4

♠ J 8 4 3
♥ J 7 6 2
♦ 6 3
♣ 10 9 3

♠ A 6 2
♥ A 10 4
♦ K 7 5
♣ K 8 6 2

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 1♦ | Pass | 2NT |
| Pass | 4♣ | Pass | 4♠ |
| Pass | 5♣ | Pass | 5♠ |
| Pass | 7NT | | |
| All Pass | | | |

7NT by South
Lead: ♠10

NORTH is just shy of a 2♣ opening bid, and when SOUTH shows 13-15 points NORTH wants to be in a slam.

NORTH cannot use Blackwood because 4NT would be a natural invitation, but with SOUTH's latest bid being 2NT he can use Gerber.

Two Major Aces and two Minor Kings fill the holes in NORTH's hand so he bids 7NT.

***Board 19***
South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A K 5
♥ 7
♦ Q 10 6 5 3
♣ K 10 8 4

♠ J 8 4 3
♥ 10 9 8 5 3 2
♦ 2
♣ 7 5

♠ Q 10 9 7 2
♥ A Q J 6
♦ A 8
♣ 6 3

♠ 6
♥ K 4
♦ K J 9 7 4
♣ A Q J 9 2

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♦ |
| Pass | 3♦ | Pass | 4♣ |
| Pass | 4♠ | Pass | 4NT[1] |
| Pass | 5♦[2] | | |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

5♦ by South
Lead: ♣7

SOUTH thinks slam may be possible, so she uses Blackwood.

And that's what Blackwood is really good for - keeping you out of slams when you are missing two Aces!

***Board 20***
North Deals
Both Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ A Q J 7 3<br>♥ A J 8 6<br>♦ 5 3<br>♣ 8 7 | |
| ♠ 10 9 6<br>♥ 7 2<br>♦ Q 9 8 4<br>♣ K Q 10 2 | | ♠ 8 5 2<br>♥ 4 3<br>♦ K J 10 2<br>♣ J 9 6 3 |
| | ♠ K 4<br>♥ K Q 10 9 5<br>♦ A 7 6<br>♣ A 5 4 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 1♠ | Pass | 2♥ |
| Pass | 3♥ | Pass | 4NT[1] |
| Pass | 5♥[2] | Pass | 6♥ |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♥ by South
Lead: ♣K

SOUTH knows NORTH has at least five ♠s, and they might provide discards for two or three of her minor suit losers.

She tries Blackwood and, sure enough, NORTH comes through with two Aces.

Even with all the Aces SOUTH knows there are not enough points for Grand, so she bids 6♥.

***Board 21***
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 6 2
♥ K Q J 7
♦ 6
♣ K Q J 10 9

♠ Q J 10 9
♥ 6 4
♦ Q 8 5 3
♣ 8 5 3

♠ 8 7 4
♥ 8 3
♦ K J 10 7 2
♣ 7 6 2

♠ K 5 3
♥ A 10 9 5 2
♦ A 9 4
♣ A 4

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 1♣ | Pass | 1♥ |
| Pass | 3♥ | Pass | 4NT[1] |
| Pass | 5♦[2] | Pass | 5NT[3] |
| Pass | 7♥ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace
3. asks for kings

7♥ by South
Lead: ♠Q

When NORTH answers Blackwood with one Ace SOUTH decides to bid 5NT to ask for Kings.

With two Kings, NORTH would bid 6♥. But she knows that if she does so, SOUTH might stop right there.

Knowing the 5NT bid guarantees all four Aces, NORTH figures her ♣ suit will supply five tricks so she bids 7♥.

***Board 22***
South Deals
None Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ 8 7<br>♥ Q 9 7 4<br>♦ K Q 5<br>♣ A 10 8 3 | |
| ♠ 9 4 3<br>♥ K 3<br>♦ J 10 9 8 2<br>♣ 9 6 2 | | ♠ J 10 6 2<br>♥ 10 8<br>♦ A 7 4 3<br>♣ 7 5 4 |
| | ♠ A K Q 5<br>♥ A J 6 5 2<br>♦ 6<br>♣ K Q J | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♥ |
| Pass | 3♥ | Pass | 4NT[1] |
| Pass | 5♦[2] | Pass | 5♥ |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

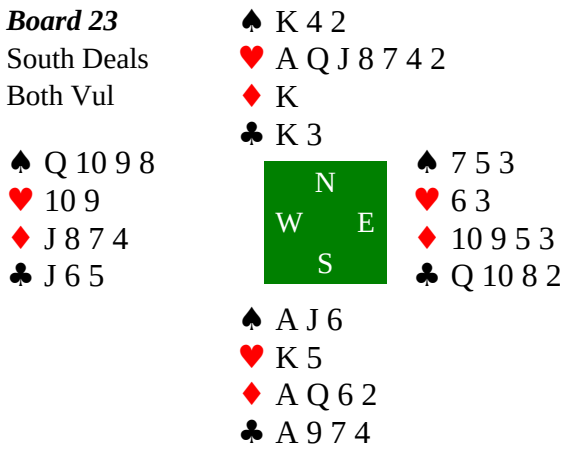
5♥ by South
Lead: ♣2

SOUTH thinks there might be slam if NORTH holds both minor Aces, so he tries Blackwood.

When NORTH shows just one Ace SOUTH is afraid he will have a trump loser as well, so he stops at 5♥.

It turns out that SOUTH might make twelve tricks, depending on the ♥K situation.

***Board 23***
South Deals
Both Vul




| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♦ |
| Pass | 1♥ | Pass | 2NT |
| Pass | 4♣ | Pass | 4NT[1] |
| Pass | 5♣[2] | Pass | 5♥ |
| Pass | 7NT | | |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces

7NT by South
Lead: ♠10

NORTH might be tempted to blast into Blackwood with his first bid, pushing toward some slam in ♥s. He chooses to temporize with a 1♥ response and is rewarded when SOUTH jumps to 2NT (18-19 points).

The Notrump bid prevents NORTH from using Blackwood, but Gerber 4♣ will work just fine. When he discovers that SOUTH holds three Aces and one King he can count thirteen tricks.

***Board 24***
North Deals
None Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ A K<br>♥ K Q 4<br>♦ K Q J 3<br>♣ K Q J 5 | |
| ♠ J 9 4<br>♥ 9 8 5 3 2<br>♦ A 8 7<br>♣ 9 2 | N<br>W E<br>S | ♠ 10 8 7 5 2<br>♥ J 6<br>♦ 10 6 4<br>♣ 7 4 3 |
| | ♠ Q 6 3<br>♥ A 10 7<br>♦ 9 5 2<br>♣ A 10 8 6 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 2♣ | Pass | 2NT |
| Pass | 4♣ | Pass | 4♠ |
| Pass | 6NT | | |
| All Pass | | | |

6NT by South
Lead: ♥8

SOUTH responds 2NT, showing 8+ points with no 5-card suit.

NORTH only needs to know how many Aces are in the SOUTH hand. He must use Gerber since 4NT in this situation would not be Blackwood.

When SOUTH shows two Aces NORTH bids 6NT.